

Evaluation of MCP for Dossier Space

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Executive Summary

This note captures an architectural evaluation of the Model Context Protocol (MCP) within the emerging Dossier Space concept. The conclusion is that MCP should be viewed as the interoperability foundation rather than the complete legal framework. Dossier Space supplies the evidential governance, custody, provenance and assurance layers.

Core Architectural Position

MCP is the standard interface connecting AI models to controlled tools and data. Dossier Space is the controlled evidential environment built around MCP.

Proposed Architecture

Human

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Bridge / Host Application

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Provider Adapters (Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, Local Qwen, etc.)

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MCP Client

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Dossier Space MCP Server

- Scope & permission checks
- Read-only enforcement
- Privilege controls
- Evidence search tools
- Source hashing
- Custody logging
- ROMER linkage
- Provenance reporting

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Evidence Repository

Infrastructure vs Interpretive Trace

Two complementary records should exist.

1. Infrastructure Trace

- Actual tools invoked
- Files accessed
- Hashes
- Timestamps

- Scope decisions
- Data returned

2. Interpretive Trace (ROMER)

- Context
- Intent
- Reasoning path
- Evidence relied upon
- Conclusions
- Assurance observations

The infrastructure trace records what actually happened. The ROMER trace records how the AI interpreted the material.

Role of MCP

MCP Provides

Standard tool interface

Model interoperability

Client/server protocol

Tool invocation

Extensibility

Provider independence

Dossier Space Provides

Evidence governance

Custody controls

Privilege enforcement

Evidence provenance

ROMER assurance

Legal workflow

Cloud and Local Modes

Cloud-mediated mode:

- Evidence remains locally controlled.
- Selected content is transmitted for inference.
- All transfers are logged.

Fully sovereign mode:

- Evidence remains local.
- MCP server remains local.
- Local inference (e.g. Ollama + Qwen).
- No evidence leaves the workstation.

Revised Development Roadmap

1. Define Dossier Space security principles.
2. Define legal MCP tool set.
3. Design custody ledger and tamper-evident logging.

4. Build read-only MCP server.
5. Connect to an existing MCP client (e.g. Claude Code/Desktop).
6. Compare infrastructure logs with ROMER traces.
7. Develop bespoke Dossier Space bridge application.
8. Add cloud provider adapters.
9. Add local inference adapter (Ollama/Qwen).
10. Evaluate local and cloud modes using identical cases.

Overall Conclusion

Dossier Space should be regarded as a model-independent evidential mediation environment. MCP provides the interoperability layer, while Dossier Space contributes custody, governance, provenance, structured analysis through Primers, and assurance through ROMER. This architecture enables both cloud-based and fully sovereign local AI deployments without changing the evidential framework.